

Daily Economic Briefing

Friday 2 October 2026 | Window: Wed 30 Sept 2026 20:00 ET – Thu 1 Oct 2026 20:20 ET (Thu 1 Oct close/AH, the window's one NYSE session) | Research cutoff 8:20pm ET Thu 1 Oct 2026 | Edition 33

Assumptions, corrections and status this edition

- Header convention re-applied: the date line is the edition date (Friday 2 October), not the session date; the window line states the given research-window start with the session covered noted parenthetically.
- Correction:** the prior edition's Brent roll estimate (approx. 16–20 October) was premature — November expired Wednesday 30 Sept at \$103.50 and December became front-month from Thursday 1 Oct.^[27]
- Correction:** an options-flow wire's reported 4.05% Citigroup decline doesn't reconcile with the confirmed stockanalysis.com close of -1.92%, which is used as authoritative; the put-skew activity is reported separately in Section 5.^{[3][34]}
- A US government shutdown was checked as a standing Oct-1 risk and did not materialize: a continuing resolution signed 2 Sept 2026 funds the government through 11 Dec 2026; Friday's jobs report stays on schedule.^{[23][24]}
- The DXY-vs-FX-crosses conflict open since Wednesday resolved cleanly this session — all sources now agree the dollar strengthened. Closed, not carried further.^{[26][32]}
- Kalshi's direct fetch remained HTTP 429-blocked for a 12th consecutive edition; secondary citations used as before.^[18]
- VIX9D's inversion below spot VIX widened for a fourth consecutive session (-1.68 → -1.83 → -2.14 → -2.39); still read as a settled vol-regime feature per standing guidance, not a live "watch for normalization" item.^[33]

60-second read

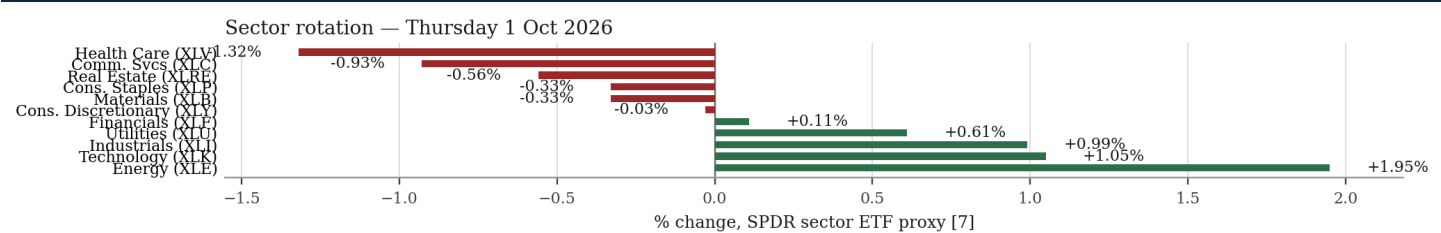
- A volatile round-trip session: the 10-year Treasury yield spiked intraday to approx. 5.34% (highest since 2002) on a hot ISM prices-paid print and a European gilt selloff, then eased back as US haven demand picked up, letting the S&P 500 snap a three-day losing streak to close +0.19% at 7,666.45; Dow +0.04% to 50,926.56, Nasdaq Composite +0.04% to 26,871.60, Russell 2000 +0.35% to 2,806.63.^[1]
- Enterprise-software and AI-infrastructure earnings dominated: Accenture +15.78% and Synopsys +12.78% jumped on AI-demand guidance raises, while an AI-datacenter-optics rally lifted Coherent +10.90%, Lumentum +7.67% and Applied Optoelectronics +8.12% on possible US curbs on Chinese transceivers.^{[3][4][5][7]}
- Nike missed fiscal Q1 revenue and guided FY27 sales to a high-single-digit percentage decline; the stock fell a further approx. 8.7% after hours on top of its regular-session dip, setting up a weak open in consumer discretionary Friday.^{[3][14]}
- October-hike odds split sharply across venues for the first time since Wednesday's collapse: Polymarket fell further to approx. 25–26% while Kalshi/CME held near 36–38%. ISM Manufacturing missed the headline (54.5% vs. approx. 54.8–55.0% consensus) but Prices Paid surged to 77.9 from 71.1 — the inflation signal that actually moved yields.^{[15][16][17][18][19]}
- Commodities/FX: the DXY-vs-crosses conflict resolved cleanly (dollar broadly stronger, GBP/USD -0.51%); gold's spot-futures split converged (both up); Brent's roll is confirmed already done, new front-month December at \$102.31.^{[26][27][29][32]}

1. Market recap

S&P 500 7,666.45 +0.19%	Dow Jones 50,926.56 +0.04%	Nasdaq Comp. 26,871.60 +0.04%	Russell 2000 2,806.63 +0.35%	VIX 16.39 +0.31%	10-yr yield 5.24% -5bp
WTI Crude \$92.87 +2.71%			Gold (spot) \$4,159.11 +0.10%		

Thursday was a round trip. A hotter-than-expected ISM prices-paid print (77.9, up from 71.1) landed alongside a European gilt selloff, dragging the 10-year intraday to approx. 5.34% (highest since 2002) and the 30-year to approx. 5.69%.^{[1][15][26]} Equities opened lower but clawed it back as yields retreated into the close on haven demand, leaving all four indices modestly higher and the S&P snapping a three-day losing streak.^[1] Energy (+1.95%) and Technology (+1.05%) led — the former on the oil rally, the latter on AI-infrastructure earnings — while Health Care (-1.32%) lagged on Danaher's and Tempus AI's declines.^[2]

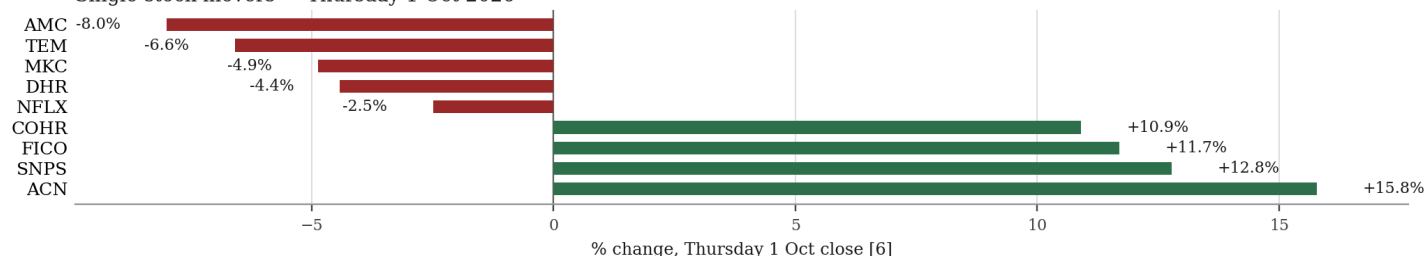
2. Equities and earnings



Five of 11 SPDR sector ETFs gained (Energy, Technology, Industrials, Utilities, Financials) and six fell (Consumer Discretionary, Materials, Consumer Staples, Real Estate, Communication Services, Health Care) — see chart for exact levels.^[2] Energy's lead tracked the oil rally on continued Iran/Strait-of-Hormuz tension; Technology's lead was carried by the software/AI-infrastructure earnings cluster below even as megacap names Alphabet (-1.70%, an adverse ad-tech jury-trial ruling) and Netflix (-2.49%, a decelerating growth guide) dragged on Communication Services.^{[13][12]} Health Care's laggard spot reflects single-name news (Danaher, Tempus AI, Moderna), not a sector-wide move.

Single-stock movers

Single-stock movers — Thursday 1 Oct 2026



Ticker	Move	Driver
ACN	+15.78%	Fiscal Q4 beat: revenue \$18.7bn vs. approx. \$18.3bn est.; guidance set above the prior range ^{[3][4]}
SNPS	+12.78%	Investor Day: OpenAI tie-up, >\$1bn AWS silicon-IP/EDA deal; FY27 guide raised to approx. \$11.15bn midpoint; new approx. \$1bn buyback ^{[3][5]}
FICO	+11.69% (then -6.35% AH)	FHFA approved FICO's Direct License mortgage-scoring program, a rebound off Wednesday's crash — but the stock gave back more than half the gain after hours to \$619.76 ^{[3][6]}
COHR	+10.90%	Launched "PhotonLink" AI-datacenter optics platform; Bernstein initiated Outperform; sector-wide optical rally on possible US curbs on Chinese transceivers ^{[3][7]}
AAOI / LITE	+8.12% / +7.67%	Rode the same AI-datacenter-optics theme as Coherent ^{[3][7]}
BA	+3.35%	Continued catch-up gain on the approx. \$20bn Navy F/A-XX fighter contract win reported Tuesday ^[3]
MU	+3.03%	Follow-through on Wednesday's after-the-bell fiscal Q4 beat (EPS \$33.42 vs. \$31.16 est.) ^[3]
NFLX	-2.49%	Guided next-quarter revenue growth to 11.7% (from 13.4%) amid competitive/engagement concerns; cited HSBC/Wells Fargo actions unconfirmed (Annex A) ^{[3][12]}
C	-1.92%	Close confirmed via stockanalysis.com, correcting a wire's erroneous -4.05% figure; heavy options put-skew activity detailed in Section 5 ^{[3][34]}
GOOGL	-1.70%	SDNY Judge P. Kevin Castel allowed a publisher ad-tech class/individual suit seeking approx. \$3.2bn in damages to proceed to jury trial ^{[3][13]}
DHR	-4.42%	CEO transition (Julie Sawyer Montgomery) read as execution risk despite Guggenheim's \$250 PT raise (Buy) ^{[3][9][11]}
MKC	-4.87%	Beat on both lines (EPS \$0.86 vs. \$0.76 est.; revenue \$2.02bn vs. \$1.98bn est.) with an in-line-to-strong FY26 guide, but sold off on dividend-safety concerns ^{[3][10]}
TEM	-6.59%	Profit-taking despite a Guggenheim PT raise to \$92 (Buy); no single negative catalyst identified ^{[3][9]}
AMC	-8.00%	Priced \$2.0bn notes + \$850mm term loan to refinance 2029 debt; cited Citi PT raise unconfirmed (Annex A) ^{[3][8]}

Earnings and guidance since Wednesday's cutoff

Accenture and McCormick both reported premarket Thursday (see table above). Nike reported fiscal Q1 FY27 results after the close: revenue of \$11.2bn missed the approx. \$11.32bn estimate and management guided full-year sales to a high-single-digit percentage decline; the stock, -0.71% at the regular close (\$35.15), fell a further approx. 8.7% after hours to approx. \$32.09 by 7:59pm ET.^{[3][14]} Northrop Grumman was roughly flat (-0.31% to \$482.00), stabilizing after Wednesday's F/A-XX-loss drop, with no fresh Thursday catalyst.^[3]

Analyst actions

- Guggenheim raised Danaher to a \$250 price target (from \$200, Buy) and Tempus AI to \$92 (from \$65, Buy).^[9]
- Bernstein initiated Coherent at Outperform; no dollar price target was independently confirmed (Annex A).^[7]
- HSBC cut Netflix to Hold and a Wells Fargo downgrade was also cited; neither action's prior rating, price target, nor exact Oct 1 dating was independently confirmed (Annex A).^[12]
- Citi reportedly raised AMC's price target to \$2.20 (from \$1.80, Sell maintained); sourced only via a single lower-tier aggregator (Annex A).^[8]

3. Macro, policy and rates

Kevin Warsh remains Fed Chair and the funds target range remains 3.75%–4.00%; the next FOMC meeting is confirmed for October 27–28, 2026 — re-verified fresh against federalreserve.gov.^[16] September's ISM Manufacturing PMI printed 54.5%, a touch below the approx. 54.8–55.0% consensus, but Prices Paid jumped to 77.9 from 71.1 against an approx. 72 estimate — the inflationary surprise behind Thursday's yield spike.^[15] October-hike odds diverged sharply across venues for the first time since Wednesday's unified collapse: Polymarket priced any hike at approx. 25–26% (no-change 75%), while Kalshi and CME secondary citations held near 36–38% — all roughly unchanged-to-firmer from Wednesday except Polymarket, which drifted further dovish.^{[17][18][19]} BoE's Bank Rate remains 3.75% (next decision Thu 5 Nov); BoJ's next meeting is confirmed for Oct 29–30 — both re-verified directly against source, though BoJ's current rate level (carried at approx. 1.25%) was not itself re-checked this edition.^{[20][21]} The US-China "30-for-30" tariff framework is unchanged, still pending domestic legal processes.^[22] A hearing in Meta's Cambridge Analytica penalty case was held Thursday (Judge Francis Mathew, New Mexico); no ruling issued, with the state seeking \$35–40bn against Meta's proposed approx. \$3.45bn cap, ruling expected within weeks.^[25]

4. Commodities and FX

Instrument	Level	Chg	Note
WTI crude	\$92.87	+2.71%	Reconciles cleanly off Wednesday's \$90.42 close ^[26]
Brent crude (Dec)	\$102.31	+4.37%	New front-month contract; % change is vs. December's own Wed close of \$98.03, not the expired Nov contract ^{[27][28]}
Henry Hub gas (Nov)	approx. \$2.98/MMBtu	-4.8¢ (intraday)	Midday quote only; no confirmed end-of-day settlement found (Annex A) ^[29]
Gold (spot)	\$4,159.11	+0.10%	Wednesday's spot-vs-futures split converged — both up Thursday ^[30]
Gold (Dec futures)	\$4,202.30	+0.37%	Normal futures basis vs. spot, not a sourcing conflict ^[26]
Silver (Dec futures)	\$61.18	+1.01%	Reversed Wednesday's decline; spot pinned to a approx. \$60.50–\$61.83 range across sources (Annex A) ^[26]
Copper (Westmetall)	\$14,335/t cash	-1.02%	LME.com/metal.com both failed again; Westmetall used as the standing fallback ^[31]
DXY	approx. 101.6–102.1	+0.17% to +0.65%	Two snapshots disagree on magnitude but agree on direction — resolves the open conflict ^{[26][32]}
GBP/USD	1.3197	-0.51%	UK gilt selloff weighed on sterling ^[32]
EUR/USD / USD/JPY	below 1.1300 / 158.05–158.33		Both consistent with broader dollar strength ^[32]
2-yr Treasury	4.78%	-10bp	Official Treasury par-yield CSV ^[26]
10-yr Treasury	5.24%	-5bp	Intraday high approx. 5.34%, highest since 2002, before easing into the close ^[26]
30-yr Treasury	5.61%	-3bp	Intraday high approx. 5.69%, highest since May 2002 ^[26]

The DXY-vs-FX-crosses conflict open since Wednesday resolved cleanly Thursday — both DXY snapshots agree with GBP/USD, EUR/USD and USD/JPY on a stronger dollar, no second-session persistence, closing without the heavier ICE-futures pass on standby.^{[26][32]} Brent's roll is confirmed via two independent sources, correcting last edition's premature approx. 16–20 October estimate.^{[27][28]} All three Treasury tenors set fresh multi-decade intraday highs before easing into the close on haven demand.^[26]

5. Derivatives, volatility and positioning

Metric	Value	Chg
VIX	16.39	+0.31%
VIX9D	14.00	-2.39 vs. VIX
VIX3M / VIX6M	18.58 / 20.52	
VVIX	92.01	+2.83%
SKEW	142.77	+0.60%

The CBOE feed gave a sixth consecutive full clean sweep, every series fresh, and the manual VIX calculation matched the feed's own field for a second straight session.^[33] VIX9D's inversion widened again, to -2.39 from -2.14 — a fourth straight session, now a settled vol-regime feature; VVIX's +2.83% jump was the more notable data point Thursday. Options flow showed heavy Citigroup put skew (approx. 2.2:1 put/call, approx. 3x existing OI) despite its confirmed -1.92% close, and heavy Medtronic put buying attributed to a large December put-spread structure rather than outright bearish positioning.^[34] zerogex.io's SPX net dealer gamma moved further toward zero (approx. -\$11.58bn from -\$14.33bn) as the spot-to-flip-point gap narrowed to 32 points — plausible given Thursday's modest SPX gain.^[35] CFTC's CoT report had not yet posted a new vintage as of cutoff; data on file remains the Tuesday 22 Sept report. The next report, covering Tuesday 29 Sept, is due on its normal Friday 2 October schedule — check first thing next edition, fetching OI/gross-long-short for ES, NQ and RTY all three.^[36] SOFR printed 3.90% for 30 Sept, 30-day average 3.75% as of 1 Oct — stable.^[37]

6. The day ahead

Date	Event	Consensus / context
Fri 2 Oct, 8:30am ET	September jobs report	Nonfarm payrolls approx. 84,000–90,000; unemployment approx. 4.1% (some risk to 4.2%); on schedule, no shutdown delay ^[24]
Mon 5 Oct, 10:00am ET	ISM Services PMI (Sept)	August read 55.4%; September consensus not yet located (Annex A) ^[38]
Thu 27–28 Oct	FOMC meeting/decision	Split across venues: Polymarket approx. 25–26% hike vs. Kalshi/CME approx. 36–38% ^{[17][18][19]}
Thu 29–30 Oct	BoJ Monetary Policy Meeting	Outlook Report due alongside decision ^[21]
Thu 5 Nov	BoE MPC decision	Bank Rate currently 3.75% ^[20]
Ongoing	Meta Cambridge Analytica ruling	Judge Mathew; expected within weeks; \$35–40bn sought vs. approx. \$3.45bn cap ^[25]

Sector setup we take into Friday's session

- Nike's after-hours guidance cut sets up a weak open in footwear/apparel and consumer discretionary broadly; FICO's regular-session gain was more than half erased after hours — the mortgage-scoring-monopoly thread stays two-sided, keep watching Equifax/TransUnion.
- The AI-infrastructure/optics trade (COHR, LITE, AAOI, ACN/SNPS) was Thursday's one clean risk-on pocket; watch if it extends into Friday's jobs-report reaction, which lands into a market split on hike odds.

Annex A — Data points sought but not verified this edition

- NYSE/Nasdaq closing breadth: not available from AP/Reuters; a single lower-tier-aggregator figure exists but was not corroborated and is not reported.
- Bernstein's exact dollar price target on its Coherent Outperform initiation.
- Citi's cited AMC price-target raise (to \$2.20 from \$1.80): single lower-tier-aggregator sourced only.
- HSBC's Netflix downgrade to Hold and a cited Wells Fargo downgrade: neither action's prior rating/price target nor its exact Oct 1 dating was independently confirmed.
- Acuity Brands' (AYI) Thursday premarket earnings: no confirmed actual results or stock reaction found.
- November Henry Hub natural gas: only a midday (approx. 12:02pm ET) quote was found; no confirmed end-of-day settlement.
- Silver spot's exact Thursday close: sources gave a range (approx. \$60.50–\$61.83), not a single pinned figure.
- September ISM Services/Non-Manufacturing consensus ahead of Monday 5 Oct's release.
- The Bank of Japan's current policy rate level (carried at approx. 1.25%) was not independently re-verified this edition — only its next meeting date was re-confirmed.
- COMEX December gold futures' precise Wednesday closing level, needed to fully double-check Thursday's reconciled % change, was not independently double-sourced.
- September nonfarm payrolls and the unemployment rate: not yet released as of this edition's research cutoff (due Friday 8:30am ET) — see Section 6.

Annex B — Sources

- [1] AP wire, "How major US stock indexes fared," Oct 1 2026, cross-checked vs. CNBC and TheStreet market-today coverage
- [2] Stockanalysis.com SPDR sector ETF price-history pages (XLE, XLK, XLC, XLY, XLP, XLRE, XLF, XLB, XLI, XLU, XLV)
- [3] Stockanalysis.com single-stock closing-price pages (ACN, SNPS, FICO, COHR, LITE, AAOI, AMC, TEM, MKC, DHR, NFLX, GOOGL, C, BA, MU, NGM, NKE)
- [4] Accenture fiscal Q4 FY26 earnings release/coverage
- [5] Synopsis 2026 Investor Day coverage (AWS/OpenAI partnerships, FY27 guidance, buyback)
- [6] GuruFocus coverage of FICO's FHFA Direct License approval and McCormick's Q3 earnings reaction
- [7] Benzinga/Yahoo Finance coverage of Coherent's PhotonLink launch and the optical-sector rally
- [8] Coverage of AMC's debt refinancing and a cited Citi price-target raise
- [9] MarketBeat/Yahoo Finance coverage of Guggenheim's Danaher and Tempus AI price-target raises
- [10] McCormick Q3 FY26 earnings release/coverage
- [11] Coverage of Danaher's CEO transition
- [12] Coverage of Netflix's guidance and cited analyst actions
- [13] Coverage of the SDNY ad-tech jury-trial ruling (Judge P. Kevin Castel) affecting Alphabet
- [14] Nike fiscal Q1 FY27 earnings release/coverage; after-hours price via stockanalysis.com
- [15] ISM/PR Newswire, "Manufacturing PMI at 54.5%; September 2026 ISM Manufacturing PMI Report"
- [16] Federalreserve.gov (Board of Governors bios; Sept 16 2026 FOMC statement; FOMC meeting calendar)
- [17] Polymarket, "Fed Decision in October?" market, direct fetch
- [18] Kalshi secondary citation (prediction-market aggregator), direct fetch
- [19] CME FedWatch secondary citations (aggregated, direct access blocked)
- [20] Bankofengland.co.uk, upcoming MPC dates page
- [21] Boj.or.jp, Monetary Policy Meeting schedule page
- [22] USTR.gov/whitehouse.gov, US-China Board of Trade release
- [23] Whitehouse.gov briefing, congress.gov CRS product R49353, and GovTrack.us on H.R. 6500 (P.L. 119-103)
- [24] BLS.gov, Employment Situation release schedule
- [25] Source NM/KRQE coverage of the Meta Cambridge Analytica penalty hearing
- [26] Investrade Market Review, Oct 1 2026 (oil, gold/silver futures, Treasury yields)
- [27] Financefeeds.com, "Brent Crude Price: The \$5.47 Gap After the \$103.50 Expiry"
- [28] Investing.com, Brent crude (December 2026 contract) quote page
- [29] News.ssbcrack.com, November Henry Hub natural gas intraday quote
- [30] Kitco PM gold report, Oct 1 2026
- [31] Westmetall.com, LME copper cash/3-month settlement data
- [32] FXStreet and a TradingEconomics-style FX aggregator, DXY and major crosses
- [33] Cdn-api.cboe.com delayed-quotes JSON feed, direct fetch, each series' last_trade_time checked individually
- [34] Investing.com options-flow wire (Citigroup, Medtronic)
- [35] Zerogex.io, SPX dealer-gamma levels page
- [36] CFTC.gov, financial_if.htm (Traders in Financial Futures)
- [37] Sofrrate.com / FRED (SOFR30DAYAVG)
- [38] Ismworld.org calendar (ISM Services PMI schedule)

Method: every figure traces to a named source in Annex B; where sources disagreed, the better-corroborated figure was used and the conflict disclosed. Nothing estimated or filled from memory — unverifiable items are listed in Annex A. Not investment advice.